

BACKGROUND MUSIC PLAYER USING JavaScript

■ BUKYA SRIDHAR

Presented here is a JavaScript-based music player with a small control panel that plays music when you browse the Internet. It can play MP3, WAV and MPG audio files. You can also use this program as a normal music player

when offline.

Normally, you can only listen to a limited online music collection provided by the streaming media service providers. You have no choice but listen to the same available music. The advantage of this music player is that you can play your own music files which are stored in your PC and enjoy your browsing time. You can place the control panel on top of a webpage or behind the webpage as a background music player.

We have millions of webpages on the Internet and some of them come with background music. The idea behind putting sound in a webpage is to give introduction of the site or a soothing experience during browsing. But, this can be annoying if only one type of music goes on playing repeatedly. One solution is to stop the



music by pressing 'Esc' key, but doing so can stop the webpage from loading further, which can hamper the browsing. Refreshing or reloading the page will restart the same audio file.

With the music player described here, if you press 'refresh' button, it will clear the music file and stop playing music until you reload the file of your liking manually.

Software program

The source code of the music player (music.htm) is given at the end of this article. JavaScript, a language of browsers, is a powerful language that's at the heart of today's Internet world after VB and Java. This particular code requires the JavaScript plug-in to be enabled. It has four interfaces/controls, namely, 'Play', 'Stop', 'Help' and 'Exit', along with 'Browse' button. The audio file can be loaded into the music player from the control panel in two ways: either by typing the path of the music file in your system or by clicking 'Browse' button to locate the music files on your computer drive, Flash drive or CD-ROM/DVD-ROM drive. When the appropriate music file is loaded into this music player, click 'Play' to play the file.

In the code, the following line invokes the play() function:

```
<input type="Button" Value="Play"
onclick="play( )">
```

The play() function scans the 'Browse' field to make sure that you have chosen a proper file to play. If the field is empty, it asks you to enter a valid path of the music file whenever you click 'Browse' button.

The following line invokes the



Fig. 1: Screenshot of the control panel of the music player



Fig. 2: Screenshot of the help dialogue box



Fig. 3: Screenshot of the exit dialogue box

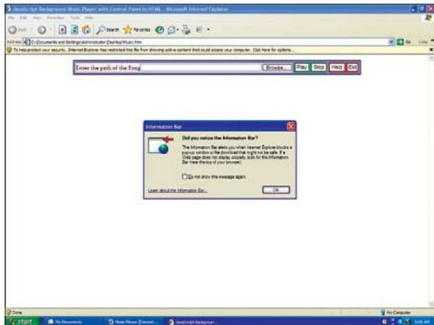


Fig. 4: Screenshot of the information bar